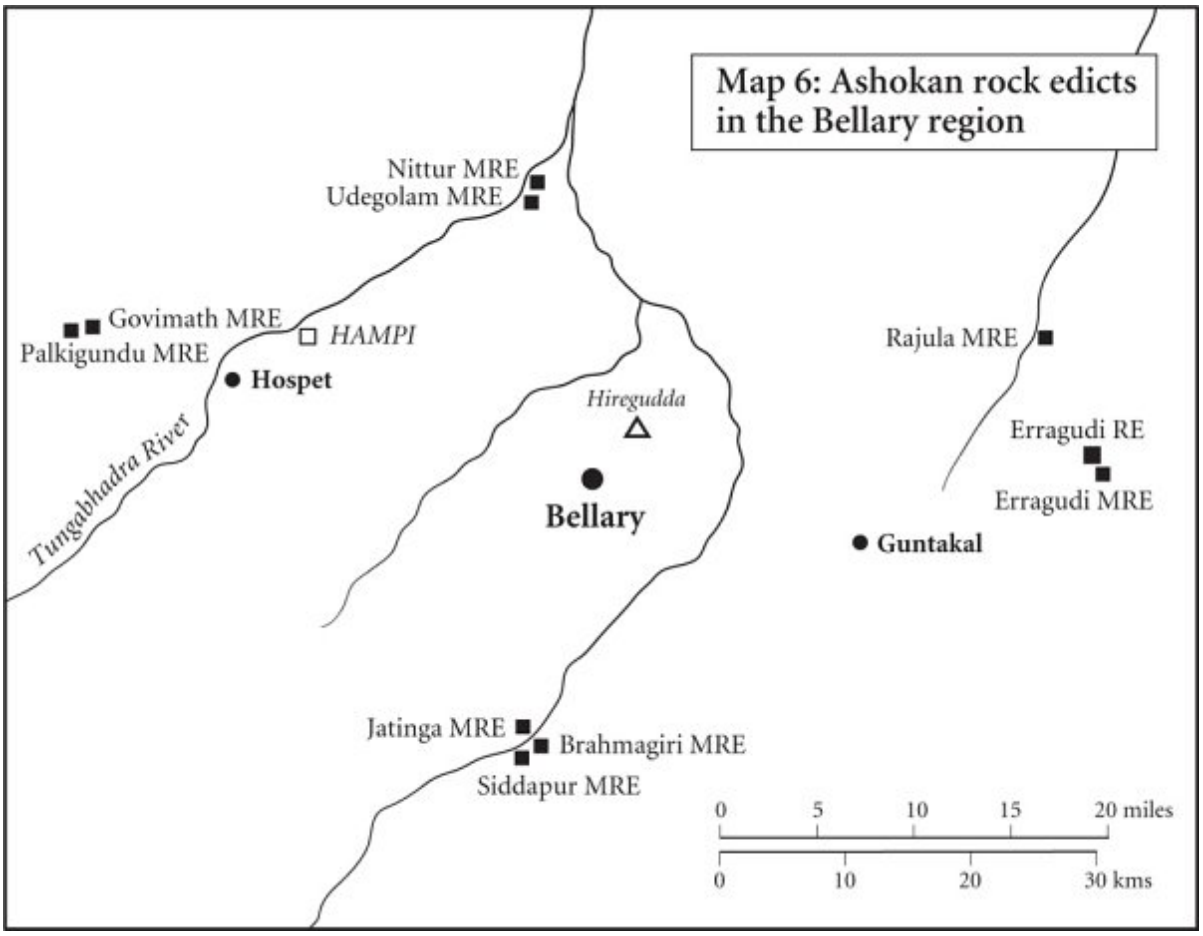
full of sorrow for the suffering caused and goes on to state that he has changed his ways and he now ‘desires non-injury, restraint and impartiality to all beings, even where wrong has been done. Now it is conquest by Dharma that Beloved-of-the-Gods considers to be the best conquest.’ He then lists all the places within and beyond his borders where the message of his Dharma is now being heard, ending with an explanation as to why he has had this edict written: ‘So that my sons and great-grandsons may not consider making new conquests, or that if military conquests are made, that they be done with forbearance and light punishment, or better still, that they consider making conquests by Dharma only, for that bears fruit in this world and the next.’



The nine Ashokan minor rock edicts found in the Bellary area of Karnataka, together with one major rock edict found at Erragudi. These